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EXPERIMENT 01
Low code versus traditional development

Aim

Compare building the Student Admission Enquiry Management System in Zoho Creator with a traditional web stack, for the same admission-office requirements.

Procedure

1. Define one common scope: student enquiry entry, status tracking (New, Admitted, Not Interested, Rejected), course and available-seat records, follow-up scheduling by mode (Call, Email, Visit), source-of-enquiry analytics, and role-based access.
2. Sketch two architectures. Low code: Creator forms, reports, Page Builder dashboard, Deluge, connections. Traditional: web UI, REST API, relational database, authentication service, CI/CD and monitoring.
3. Trace one transaction (moving an enquiry from New to Admitted) through both. Note where status validation, authorization and notification are enforced.
4. Break work into data model, interface, business rules, testing, integration, deployment. Record measured time if you build both; otherwise label every figure 'estimate'.
5. Score each approach 1 to 5 against criteria with weights fixed before scoring. Do not claim the result is universal.

Implementation and verification

Criterion	Creator approach	Traditional approach
Initial delivery	Forms, reports, kanban views and dashboard charts are built visually; the five screens (Dashboard, Enquiries, Statuses, Courses, Follow Up) need no custom front-end code.	UI, API, database and kanban/chart components must be assembled.
Customization	Deluge, widgets and APIs within platform limits.	Full control of libraries and runtime.
Operations	Managed hosting; plan limits (trial, records, API calls) matter.	Team runs hosting, backups, upgrades.
Portability	Export data; proprietary logic must be rewritten.	Depends on chosen services.
Cost	Per-user licensing, plan capacity.	Development, hosting, support.

Weighted scoring sheet (weights fixed before scoring; all scores are **estimates** for a small single-office admission team, not measurements):

Criterion	Weight %	Creator (1-5)	Traditional (1-5)
Time to deliver first version	25	5	2
Customization freedom	20	3	5
Operations effort	15	4	2
Portability	10	2	4
Cost for small team	15	4	2
Security and governance control	15	3	4
Weighted total (out of 5)	100	**3.70**	**3.10**

Evidence and testing

E01: architecture sketches, requirements checklist, weighted scoring sheet, labelled estimates. Scoring was done for this project's size only; a larger multi-campus scenario is analysed separately in Experiment 13. No build time was measured for the traditional stack, so all time and cost comparisons are estimates.

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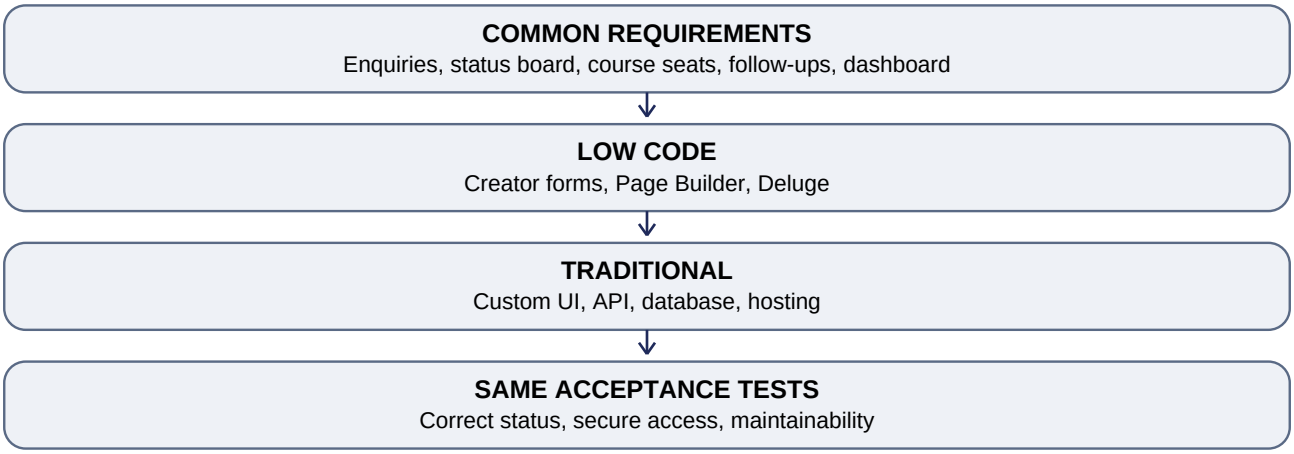
Process diagram



Generated explanatory diagram. It is not a screenshot of an executed workflow.

Result

Expected result and verification criteria. The comparison shows where Creator suits a routine admission-enquiry workflow and where custom code may be justified. All cost and time values are labelled as measured or estimated.